

1.3 Empathy Map Canvas

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Project: Hospital Appointment Management System **Platform:** ServiceNow (Scoped Application) **Phase:** Ideation **Primary Persona:** Patient

About This Empathy Map

An empathy map is a design-thinking tool used to build a shared understanding of a user's experience by capturing what they say, think, do, and feel. The Patient was selected as the primary persona for this map because patients are the largest and most frequent user group of the system, and their pain points around visibility and control over appointment booking are the core driver of the project.

SAYS

What the patient says out loud (to staff, on the phone, to family)

- "Can you just tell me if the doctor has any slot open this week?"
- "I've called three times already and no one can confirm my appointment."
- "Why do I have to keep calling back to check if a slot opened up?"
- "Is there a way I can just book online instead of coming in person?"
- "Nobody told me my appointment got cancelled."

THINKS

What the patient thinks but doesn't say out loud

- "This shouldn't be this complicated — I just want to see a doctor."
- "What if I show up and there's no record of my booking?"
- "I wonder if someone else already took the slot I was told was open."
- "I don't trust that the front desk actually wrote my appointment down correctly."
- "There has to be a faster way to do this in this day and age."

DOES

Observable actions and behaviors

- Calls the clinic multiple times over several days to check slot availability
- Visits the clinic in person just to confirm a booking, even when a phone call should suffice
- Writes down appointment details manually (date, time, doctor) to avoid relying on the clinic's memory
- Arrives early "just in case" the appointment time was recorded incorrectly
- Asks front-desk staff to repeat the appointment details back to confirm

FEELS

Emotions and pain points experienced

- Frustrated by the lack of transparency into doctor availability
- Anxious about whether the booking was actually recorded correctly
- Powerless — dependent entirely on staff availability and memory
- Disrespected when appointments are lost or double-booked without explanation
- Relieved only after receiving direct, repeated confirmation

PAINS

Frustrations, obstacles, and risks

- No real-time visibility into which doctors have open slots on which dates
- Risk of double-booking, where two patients are told the same slot is available
- No structured waitlist — if a preferred slot is full, the patient must simply keep calling back
- No self-service way to view, reschedule, or cancel an existing appointment
- No confirmation trail — appointments exist only in a register or a staff member's memory

GAINS

Wants, needs, and measures of success

- A clear, real-time view of available doctor slots before committing to a visit
- Confidence that a booked appointment is guaranteed and correctly recorded
- Ability to join a waitlist and be automatically notified/promoted if a slot opens up
- A simple way to view appointment history and cancel or manage bookings independently
- Reduced need for repeated phone calls or in-person visits just to confirm basic information

Design Implication

The empathy map makes clear that the patient's core need is **trust through visibility** — a system that shows real availability, confirms bookings reliably, and removes the guesswork currently created by manual, staff-dependent processes. This directly informed the decision to build a real-time slot booking interface with atomic (conflict-free) booking transactions and an automated waitlist promotion mechanism, so patients no longer have to rely on repeated calls or in-person visits to get a definitive answer.

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